

SAL-05 · SALARY AND SKILLS REPORT

Report template and data tables

The complete shell of the annual report, structurally finished and deliberately empty

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The full section structure of the Institute's annual salary and skills report: every table with its columns defined and every cell carrying the placeholder [DATA], every chart specified in words, the mandatory methodology and limitations sections written out, and the standing caveats that must appear in every edition. No data has been collected, so no table contains a value. This is the shell into which field data will be dropped, and the rules that govern what may be dropped into it.

— About this document

Document	SAL-05
Series	Salary and Skills Report
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	6

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Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

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Report template and data tables

In one paragraph. This is the full section structure of the Institute's annual salary and skills report: every table with its columns defined and every cell carrying the placeholder `[DATA]`, every chart specified in words, the mandatory methodology and limitations sections written out, and the standing caveats that must appear in every edition. No data has been collected, so no table contains a value. This is the shell into which field data will be dropped, and the rules that govern what may be dropped into it.

Who this is for. The analysts and editors who will produce the report; reviewers checking that the published edition matches the structure that was committed to in advance; and readers who want to inspect the apparatus before there is anything in it to argue about.

— 1. What this shell is, and the rule that governs it

Every table below is complete in its columns and empty in its cells. `[DATA]` marks a value that field data will supply. Each table carries the label **structure only — no data collected**, and that label stays until the survey has been run, analysed and reviewed.

The governing rule: the structure is fixed before the data arrives. An analyst who sees the results first and designs the tables second will — without any dishonest intention — design tables that show what the data happens to say. Fixing the shell in advance means the report's shape cannot be tuned to its findings, and a reader can compare the published edition against this document to check.

Three consequences follow, and they are not negotiable:

- **A table whose cells are suppressed is still published, empty, with the suppression rule named.** Missing cells are the report's most honest content.
- **A table cannot be added after the data is seen** except in the "additional analysis" section (§11), which exists so that genuine discoveries have somewhere to go while remaining visibly separate from the pre-committed structure.
- **A table cannot be removed** because it turned out thin. It is published with its cells suppressed.

— 2. Report front matter

Element	Content
Title	Project Controls Salary and Skills Report <u>[CONFIRM: edition year, reference date and intended publication date]</u>
Publisher	Project Controls Institute Global, Inc.
Edition and version	Edition number, version, date of issue
Citation	<u>[CONFIRM: the citation string readers should use, and whether a persistent identifier is registered]</u>
Licence	<u>[CONFIRM: licence terms for reuse of figures and charts, including whether attribution is required and whether commercial reuse is permitted]</u>
Dataset	<u>[CONFIRM: whether an anonymised dataset is released alongside the report, under what terms, and after what disclosure review]</u>
Accessible formats	<u>[CONFIRM: which formats are produced, and who signs off alt text and table linearisation before release]</u>
Foreword	<u>[CONFIRM: foreword signatory and their governance role]</u>
Contact	hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

The cover carries no figure. A headline number on a cover is quoted more often than it is read, and it travels without its denominator.

— 3. Section map

§	Section	Mandatory	Contains
1	How to read this report	Yes	The five questions to ask of any figure; pointer to SAL-06
2	What was measured	Yes	Scope, unit of analysis, reference period, definitions
3	Methodology summary	Yes	Condensed SAL-01 , with the full text as Annex A
4	Who responded	Yes	Sample composition against every characteristic collected
5	Reward by role and level	Yes	The core reward tables
6	Reward by context	Yes	Sector, region, employer type, contract environment
7	Remuneration components	Yes	Base, allowances, variable pay, overtime, retirement, benefits prevalence
8	Day-rate engagements	Yes	Reported separately from salaried reward, never merged
9	Skills	Yes	Held capability, reported requirement, capability gap
10	AI in controls work	Yes	Use, sanction, validation practice, training
11	Satisfaction, mobility and transparency	Yes	Attitudinal findings
12	Additional analysis	No	Anything discovered after the shell was fixed, labelled as such
13	Limitations	Yes	What this report cannot tell you
14	Standing caveats	Yes	Reproduced verbatim from §12 of this document
15	Change log	Yes	Every instrument, taxonomy and method change since the last edition
—	Annexes	Yes	A: methodology · B: instrument · C: role taxonomy · D: skills codebook · E: suppression log · F: full rankings

— 4. Section 1 — How to read this report (standing text)

This section is reproduced in every edition, adjusted only for the edition's specifics.

Every figure in this report is a summary of what a defined group of respondents told us, over a defined period, about a defined component of their pay. It is not a rate, a recommendation or a target.

Five questions to ask of any figure here, or anywhere else:

1. **Who was asked?** Look at the sample composition in §4 before reading any figure.
2. **How many answered this?** Every figure carries its own response count. A figure without one has been quoted incorrectly.
3. **What exactly is being measured?** Base pay, total cash and a day rate are three different quantities. The column heading tells you which.
4. **When?** Every figure refers to the reference period stated in §2.
5. **In what currency and on what basis?** Amounts are converted at a single reference date and are stated gross. Converted figures compare nominal amounts, not living standards.

Where a cell is empty, it is empty because publishing it would have breached one of our disclosure rules — most often because too few people answered. The rule applied is named in the cell and listed in Annex E. We do not fill those gaps with estimates.

Guidance on using figures like these in a real pay conversation is published separately as [SAL-06 – Using market data honestly](#).

— 5. Section 4 — Who responded

Composition is reported before any reward figure, deliberately, so no reader reaches a median before they know who produced it.

Table 1 — Responses by role and level. Structure only — no data collected.

Role	Foundation	Practitioner	Professional	Leader	Total
Planner / scheduler	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Cost engineer	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Cost controller	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Estimator	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Risk analyst	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Change / commercial controller	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Reporting and data analyst	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Project controls lead	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Project controls manager	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Head of project controls	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Other / unmatched	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Total	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 2 — Responses by region and country. Structure only — no data collected.

Region	Countries with responses	Responses	Countries meeting the publication threshold
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 3 — Responses by employer type and sector. Structure only — no data collected.

Employer type	Responses	Sectors represented	Largest single sector share
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 4 — Responses by engagement type and working pattern. Structure only — no data collected.

Engagement type	Full time	Part time	Rotational	Total
Permanent employee	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Fixed-term employee	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Day-rate contractor	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Agency worker	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Self-employed	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Seconded	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 5 — Responses by experience band and qualification. Structure only — no data collected.

Experience band	Responses	Highest qualification distribution	Holding any certification
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 6 — Item-level completion. Structure only — no data collected. This table exists because skipping is informative: it shows which questions people would not answer.

Question	Shown to	Answered	Answered "prefer not to say"	Skipped
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 7 — Data preparation. Structure only — no data collected.

Stage	Records	Reason
Responses received	[DATA]	—
Removed: screened out	[DATA]	Failed eligibility at Q02 or Q05
Removed: duplicates	[DATA]	Same respondent, multiple submissions
Removed: quality rule	[DATA]	Completion time below the pre-set floor, or straight-lined matrices
Items excluded: unit error	[DATA]	Ambiguous period or currency, not correctable
Items excluded: outlier rule	[DATA]	Pre-declared rule in SAL-01 §8
Analysis dataset	[DATA]	—

— 6. Sections 5 and 6 — Reward tables

Every reward table uses the same column grammar, so that a reader who learns to read one can read all of them.

Standard reward table columns.

Column	Definition
Cell	The population the row describes, fully specified
n	Unweighted count of respondents answering this item in this cell
Employer test	Result of the dominance test in SAL-01 §6 rule 3: pass, or the rule that suppressed the cell
Lower quartile	The value below which a quarter of responses fall
Median	The middle value
Upper quartile	The value below which three-quarters of responses fall
Component	Which remuneration component the figures measure
Basis	Currency, gross or net, and period
Note	Suppression rule, combination applied, or other qualification

Table 8 — Base pay by role and level. Structure only — no data collected. Component: base pay only, excluding allowances, variable pay and overtime. Basis: converted to the report's base currency at the reference date, gross, annualised.

Role	Level	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
Planner / scheduler	Foundation	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Planner / scheduler	Practitioner	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Planner / scheduler	Professional	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Planner / scheduler	Leader	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
(repeated for each of the ten roles in SAL-03 §3, at each of the four levels)							

Table 9 — Base pay by role group and region. Structure only — no data collected. Combination is permitted only along the hierarchy in [SAL-03](#) §6, and every combined cell says so in the Note column.

Role group	Region	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
Cost and commercial	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Planning and risk	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Data and reporting	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Controls leadership	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 10 — Base pay by sector. Structure only — no data collected. One row per sector option at Q15.

Sector	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 11 — Base pay by employer type. Structure only — no data collected.

Employer type	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 12 — Base pay by experience band, within level. Structure only — no data collected. Reported within level, never across it, because experience and level are not independent.

Level	Experience band	n	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 13 — Distribution detail. Structure only — no data collected. Published only for cells with 100 or more responses, per SAL-01 §6 rule 2. Cells below that threshold appear here as suppressed, not omitted.

Cell	n	10th percentile	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	90th percentile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 14 — Working pattern and cross-border arrangement. Structure only — no data collected. Rotational, assignment and remote-cross-border respondents are reported separately and never pooled with locally employed respondents in the same cell.

Arrangement	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
Locally employed and resident	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Rotational	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
International assignment	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Remote from another country	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

7. Section 7 — Remuneration components

Components are reported separately. There is no "total reward" table, and there will not be one until the Institute can construct it from components collected on a consistent basis for the same respondents — at which point it will be published alongside the components, never instead of them.

Table 15 — Prevalence of each component, by role group. Structure only — no data collected. Prevalence is the share of respondents in the cell who report receiving the component at all.

Component	Cost and commercial	Planning and risk	Data and reporting	Controls leadership	n per cell
Fixed allowances (any)	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Variable pay scheme	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Paid overtime	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Employer retirement contribution	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 16 — Allowance types received. Structure only — no data collected. Prevalence only.

Allowance type	Respondents receiving it	n answering the item	Note
Site or location	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Rotation or offshore	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Housing	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Transport or car	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Travel or subsistence	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Cost-of-living or hardship	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Other fixed allowance	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 17 — Variable pay, target against paid. Structure only — no data collected. Target and actual are shown in adjacent columns and never averaged together.

Cell	n with a scheme	Target — lower quartile / median / upper quartile	Paid — lower quartile / median / upper quartile	Received nothing	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 18 — Non-cash benefits prevalence. Structure only — no data collected. Benefits are never assigned a monetary value; see SAL-02 Q34.

Benefit	Respondents receiving it	n answering the item
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 19 — Pay change during the period, by reason. Structure only — no data collected. Reasons and direction only. No magnitude, because the design cannot support one.

Reason	Respondents	n answering the item
No change	[DATA]	[DATA]
Annual review	[DATA]	[DATA]
Promotion	[DATA]	[DATA]
Change of employer	[DATA]	[DATA]
Change of engagement type	[DATA]	[DATA]
Reduction	[DATA]	[DATA]

— 8. Section 8 — Day-rate engagements

A separate section, not a column in the salaried tables. The two are different quantities and the report never converts between them; the reasons are set out for readers in [SAL-06 §6](#).

Table 20 — Day rates by role and level. Structure only — no data collected. Basis: rate received by the respondent, per day, converted at the reference date. Rates charged by an agency to a client are reported separately in Table 21 and never mixed into this one.

Role	Level	n	Employer test	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 21 — Rates reported as charged to the client. Structure only — no data collected. Reported separately and labelled, because this is a different measurement from what the worker receives.

Role group	n	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 22 — Days worked and costs borne. Structure only — no data collected. Published adjacent to the rate tables so that no reader takes a rate as an income.

Cell	n	Days worked — banded distribution	Respondents bearing own insurance	Own retirement provision	Own training	Umbrella or accountancy fees
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

— 9. Section 9 — Skills

All skills tables use the constructs defined in [SAL-04 §6](#) and name the construct in the table title.

Table 23 — Held capability, by skill and role group. Structure only — no data collected. Construct: held capability (self-assessed against behavioural anchors).

Skill code	Skill	Cost and commercial	Planning and risk	Data and reporting	Controls leadership	n per cell
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 24 — Reported requirement, by skill and role group. Structure only — no data collected. Construct: skill explicitly required of the respondent, in a documented form, within the reference period. This table is never captioned or quoted as "demand".

Skill code	Skill	Cost and commercial	Planning and risk	Data and reporting	Controls leadership	n per cell
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 25 — Capability gap, computed within respondent. Structure only — no data collected. Construct: explicitly required at the requirement item **and** held at one of the two lowest anchors, for the same respondent.

Skill code	Skill	Respondents with the gap	n answering both items	Note
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 26 — Tool categories used, by role group. Structure only — no data collected. Categories only; no product is named in any counted form.

Tool category	Cost and commercial	Planning and risk	Data and reporting	Controls leadership	n per cell
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 27 — Free-text coding outcome. Structure only — no data collected. The taxonomy's own error report.

Measure	Value
Free-text segments coded	[DATA]
Segments coded UNC (unmatched)	[DATA]
Share double-coded	[DATA]
Agreement statistic and value	[DATA]
Adjudicated disagreements	[DATA]
Codebook version used	[DATA]

— 10. Sections 10 and 11 — AI use, satisfaction and mobility

Table 28 — AI tool use by task, by role group. Structure only — no data collected. Labelled with the reference period wherever it is reproduced, per [SAL-04](#) §7 rule 6.

Task	Cost and commercial	Planning and risk	Data and reporting	Controls leadership	n per cell
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 29 — Sanction and validation practice. Structure only — no data collected. The two questions are reported together because either alone is misleading.

Sanction status	Checks all output	Checks material parts	Reviewed by a colleague	Normal review only	Used as produced	n
Policy exists and permits it	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Permitted informally	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
No policy exists	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Prohibited	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]
Don't know	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 30 — Satisfaction with reward and with role, by level. Structure only — no data collected. Reported as distributions across the five scale points, never as a single mean score.

Level	Reward — distribution across five points	Role — distribution across five points	n
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 31 — Mobility intention and stated reasons. Structure only — no data collected.

Cell	n	Distribution across likelihood points	Reasons selected (multi-select, sums above the total)
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 32 — Pay transparency arrangement at the employer. Structure only — no data collected. Reported without any statement that one arrangement is preferable or required; transparency law differs by jurisdiction and the report takes no position on any jurisdiction's.

Arrangement	Respondents	n
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

Table 33 — Cross-cycle comparison eligibility. Structure only — no data collected. Completed before any comparison is written, and published whether or not any comparison passed.

Cell	n this cycle	n prior cycle	Question wording unchanged	Code or definition unchanged	Comparison permitted
[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

11. Chart specifications

Charts are specified in words here so that the visual design cannot quietly change what the data says. Every chart carries its response count in the subtitle — not the caption, not a footnote — and every chart respects the suppression rules; a suppressed cell is drawn as an explicit gap with a label, never interpolated, never omitted so that the axis closes over it.

Chart	Question it answers	Mark and encoding	Axis rules	Must not
C1 Sample composition	Who responded	Stacked horizontal bars, one bar per role, segments by level	Count axis from zero	Use a pie chart; imply the sample is the profession
C2 Base pay distribution by level	How spread out is pay within a level	Box plot per level: quartiles as the box, whiskers to the tenth and ninetieth percentiles where n permits	Value axis from zero; identical scale across panels	Draw whiskers where the distribution-detail threshold is not met
C3 Base pay by role group	How role groups compare	Grouped box plots, one panel per region meeting the threshold	Shared scale across panels	Rank groups by median without showing overlap
C4 Component prevalence	Which components a cell actually receives	Horizontal bars, one per component	Share axis from zero to whole	Stack components as though they sum to a total reward
C5 Day rate against days worked	Why a rate is not an income	Two adjacent distributions, rate and days, on separate axes	Separate panels, never a dual axis	Multiply one by the other, in the chart or in the caption
C6 Skills — required against held	Where the gaps are	Paired bars per skill, requirement and capability adjacent	Common share axis	Draw a connecting line implying a per-person gap; the gap has its own chart
C7 Capability gap	The within-respondent gap	Horizontal bars, ordered, with tied ranks shown as a shared band	Share axis from zero	Truncate the axis; show only the top of the ranking
C8 AI use by sanction status	Whether use is governed	Small multiples, one panel per sanction status	Identical scale across panels	Combine panels into a single total that hides the governance split
C9 Satisfaction distribution	How opinion is spread	Diverging stacked bars centred between the middle points	Symmetric about the centre	Reduce the distribution to a mean score

Accessibility rules for every chart. No meaning is carried by colour alone — every encoding is also carried by position, pattern or a direct label. Each chart has alt text describing what it shows and what the reader should take from it, and each has an accompanying table so that the same content is available linearly.

Two prohibitions that apply to all charts. No trend line is drawn through fewer than three comparable cycles. No chart places pay against any respondent characteristic in a way that implies causation, because a cross-sectional survey cannot support a causal claim in either direction.

— 12. Section 13 — Limitations (standing text)

Reproduced in every edition, extended where an edition has a specific additional limitation.

This is a volunteer sample. Respondents chose to take part. It is not a random sample of project controls professionals, and no statistical technique in this report converts it into one. Figures describe the people who answered.

Composition drives everything. Read §4 before any figure. A cell that is mostly one region, one sector or one employer describes that region, sector or employer.

Self-report. Pay, skills and level are as reported by respondents. We validate internal consistency and correct unambiguous unit errors; we cannot verify a payslip.

Cross-sectional. This report describes one period. It cannot establish that anything causes anything else — not experience, not sector, not certification, not skills.

Currency conversion compares nominal amounts. It says nothing about purchasing power, tax, social contributions or what any of it buys where the respondent lives.

Jurisdictions differ. Employment law, tax treatment, mandatory retirement provision, benefit norms and pay-transparency requirements vary by country. Nothing here should be read as describing any jurisdiction's rules.

Suppression is not absence. An empty cell means we would not publish it, not that nobody works in that role. Annex E lists every suppression and the rule applied.

The gaps are where the need is greatest. Smaller markets and specialist roles are the hardest to report and the most poorly served by existing data. We would rather leave the cell empty than fill it with something we cannot defend.

— 13. Section 14 — Standing caveats (verbatim block)

Reproduced without alteration in every edition, in the report, in the executive summary, and in any extract or slide deck the Institute publishes from it.

What this report is. A summary of what a self-selected group of project controls professionals told us about their roles, their pay and their skills, over one defined period, under the published methodology.

What it is not. It is not a rate card, a pay recommendation, a benchmark for setting an individual's pay, or a forecast. It does not state what any role "should" pay.

On certification and pay. Nothing in this report should be read as a claim that holding any certification — including the Institute's own — produces a pay outcome. PCI makes no claim of guaranteed employment or salary outcomes. Where certification status appears in this report it is a respondent characteristic, and a cross-sectional survey cannot establish causation.

On the Institute's status. PCI's certifications are developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles. PCI is not accredited by any ISO/IEC 17024 accreditation body.

On independence. No sponsor, employer, recruitment business or vendor saw these results before publication, chose which analyses were published, or had any role in the methodology.

On correction. If a figure here is wrong, we will correct it publicly, on the same channels that carried it, with a dated note in this document.

— 14. Section 15 — Change log

Table 34 — Changes since the previous edition. Structure only — no data collected. Completed for every edition including the first, where it records the baseline.

Item changed	Type	Previous	Current	Effect on comparability
[DATA]	Instrument wording / option set / routing / taxonomy / codebook / method / suppression rule	[DATA]	[DATA]	[DATA]

A change with an effect on comparability breaks that series. The break is stated in the affected table, not only here.

— 15. Completion rules for the analyst

1. Populate the shell in the order the sections appear. Composition tables are completed and reviewed before any reward table is populated.
2. Run the suppression tests before formatting anything. A suppressed cell keeps its row.
3. Never delete a row or column because it is empty.
4. Never add a table outside §12 (additional analysis).
5. Every figure carries its own n. If a figure cannot be given an n, it cannot be published.
6. Write the caption before the number is in the cell, so the caption describes the measurement rather than the result.
7. Reproduce §12 and §13 of the report verbatim. They are not edited for tone, length or edition.
8. Complete Table 33 before writing any sentence comparing this cycle with the last.
9. Hand the populated draft to a reviewer who has not seen the data, together with this document, and ask them to find any structural difference.

— 16. How this goes wrong

A headline appears on the cover. The single number that summarises nothing becomes the thing everyone quotes. The rule in §2 exists to prevent it, and it will be argued about every year.

Empty tables are quietly dropped. The report looks tidier and the reader loses the most informative content in it — the record of what could not be said.

Components are summed into total reward because a reader asked for one number. The result is a total built from different components for different respondents, which is the exact error §7 exists to prevent.

A day rate is annualised. Someone multiplies a rate by a plausible number of days and prints it beside a salary. Chart C5's prohibition is written down because this will be proposed.

The chart improves the finding. An axis is truncated to make a difference visible, or a suppressed category is dropped so the bars sit neatly. Both are misrepresentations, and both look like design decisions.

The report is careful and the promotion is not. The caveats are in the document, and the post says "the most in-demand skill in project controls". The standing caveats bind every extract for this reason.

— 17. Checklist — before the populated report is released

- [] Structure matches this document; any difference is deliberate, recorded and justified
- [] Composition tables completed and reviewed before any reward figure was populated
- [] Every cell either contains a figure with an n, or names the suppression rule applied
- [] No table added outside the additional-analysis section; no table removed
- [] No total-reward figure constructed from components collected inconsistently
- [] Day rates and salaries reported separately, with no conversion anywhere in text or chart
- [] Table 33 completed before any cross-cycle statement was written
- [] Standing caveats reproduced verbatim, including in the summary and any slide extract
- [] Limitations section present, complete and unedited except for additions
- [] Annexes A–F all present, including the suppression log and the full rankings
- [] Every chart carries its n in the subtitle, and its alt text and companion table
- [] No colour-only encoding; every chart readable in greyscale
- [] No claim of causation anywhere, including in the foreword
- [] No accreditation, endorsement or pay-outcome claim anywhere, including in the promotional copy

— Related

- [SAL-01 – Salary and skills report – framework and methodology](#) — the rules that decide what may enter these cells
- [SAL-02 – The survey instrument](#) — the questions each table draws from, by number
- [SAL-03 – Role taxonomy and levelling](#) — the row labels and the permitted aggregation hierarchy
- [SAL-04 – The skills demand taxonomy](#) — the constructs and vocabulary behind the skills tables
- [SAL-06 – Using market data honestly](#) — the reader-facing companion referenced in the report's own §1

— Sources and standards

No external source is cited, and no cell in this document contains a value. The structure draws on the Institute's own methodology ([SAL-01](#)), instrument ([SAL-02](#)), taxonomy ([SAL-03](#)) and skills vocabulary ([SAL-04](#)), and on the accreditation and independence wording fixed in [00-framework/CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#) §2.1. Currency conversion follows the source and reference date fixed under [SAL-01](#) §9.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.